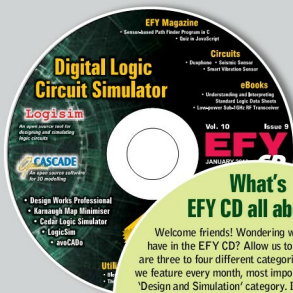


# Your New Year Gifts

While the theme of this month's CD is digital circuit simulation, we have covered other useful software too. Here's a list of some of the cool applications for you to try out.



## What's EFY CD all about?

Welcome friends! Wondering what goodies we have in the EFY CD? Allow us to reveal all! There are three to four different categories of software that we feature every month, most important of which is the 'Design and Simulation' category. It comprises various electronics software, datasheets, e-books, circuit ideas and EFY software. The CD also contains three other sections: Resources, Fun and Utility. 'Resources' contains essential software like Acrobat Reader, Enzip and a few others, which form the basic requirements of any PC. The 'Fun' segment includes computer games, whereas in 'Utilities' you will find multimedia and IDE software, Internet applications, etc.

### Blender (Utilities, 10.8 MB)

Blender is a 3D graphics designing application that operates under the GNU GPL v2 or later licences. It is a cross-platform software and its latest stable version available is 2.49b. The software is written in C, C++ and Python. The newer and alpha version of Blender 2.5 was released on November 24, 2009.

The software offers features like modeling, UV unwrapping, texturing, rigging, shading, rendering, particles and simulations, non-linear editing, imaging and compositing, animation, Python scripting, 3D game creation, etc.

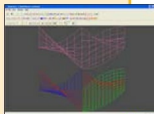
Blender has been used in production of animated movies like *Elephant Dreams* (2005), *Big Buck Bunny* (2007) and *Yo Frankie!* (2008). It runs on Windows, Linux, and Mac OS. The minimum hardware requirement of this software is 300MHz CPU, 128MB RAM, 20MB free hard disk space and Open GL graphics card with 16GB RAM. For more information on the software visit <http://www.blender.org/>



### Open Cascade (Designing tools, 174 MB)

Open Cascade, a software development platform for 3D CAD, CAM and CAE, is supported by Open Cascade S.A.S.. The current stable version of the software is Open Cascade 6.3 written in C++. It can be used by industries, research institutes, universities or individuals. The fundamental functionality of the Open Cascade technology is modeling data. Any object can be created in 2D or 3D geometry using this software. There are other features too, using which you can create chamfers, draft and offset shapes. An interesting feature of this software is visualisation, which lets you view an object in different modes.

Open Cascade also gives you the freedom to adapt, modify and enrich the code as per your requirements. The software comes with a complete support, for which the user has to pay a nominal fee. But the fee is charged for support, not licence. The software finds applications in various industrial domains, aeronautics and space, automotive, shipbuilding, etc. BMW and Tata Motors use this software in the automobile industry and CIRTES in the medical sector. The minimum system requirement for the software is 256MB, 500MB memory space and OpenGL graphics library. For more information visit <http://opencascade.org>



### avoCADo

(Designing Tools, 8.5 MB)

avoCADo is an open source software for 3D modeling, 3D rendering and visualisation. Target users for this software are engineers and artists. The latest version of the software available is 8.03 preAlpha, which is being distributed under the GNU GPL licence. The programming language used in this software is Java. Improvements in the software include a revolve tool to build menu; you can now reference arcs by unique IDs or sketch new faces after a build operation or select material. It also includes lots of CSG debugging features and an updated graphics.

avoCADo has its own wiki, which can be viewed at [http://sourceforge.net/apps/mediawiki/avocadocad/index.php?title=Main\\_Page](http://sourceforge.net/apps/mediawiki/avocadocad/index.php?title=Main_Page). The wiki is basically a tutorial which explains how to use the software. Further, it explains the basic requirements to start the development for the software. Also, source code for the software is available here. The software has been built for cross-platform usage, hence it runs on Linux and Mac OS. For more information visit <http://avocadocad.sourceforge.net/>

